ST FRANCIS CATHOLIC SECONDARY SCHOOL, LAGOS *The Jesuit-Run Catholic College*



History

JSS 1

First Term

2026/2027

JSS 1 HISTORY – FIRST TERM SCHEME OF WORK

WEEK	TOPIC
Week 1	Introduction to History
Week 2	History vs Storytelling
Week 3	Importance of Studying History
Week 4	Characteristics of History
Week 5	Sources of History (Overview)
Week 6	Primary Sources of History
Week 7	Mid-term Break
Week 8	Secondary Sources of History
Week 9	Tertiary Sources of History
Week 10	Ways of Accessing History
Week 11	Importance of History (Expanded)
Week 12	History Makers
Week 13	Revision and Examination

Week 1 – Introduction to History

Date	Week 1
Topic	Introduction to History
Objectives / Learning Outcomes	Define history, explain its origin, and differentiate it from storytelling
Summary (Insight)	History is the study of past human events based on facts.
Key Words / New Terms	History, Past, Origin, Storytelling
Application	I can ask elders about our family's past and verify historical facts.
Student Engagement:	
What I Have Learnt?	
Skills Acquired	
My Question(s) / Evaluation	
Action Goal	

WEEK 1

INTRODUCTION TO HISTORY

MEANING OF HISTORY

1. History is the study and documentation of past human activities, detailing how individuals and societies lived, governed, traded, and transformed over time.

2. It promotes an understanding of our origins, values, identities, and the links between past and present.

3. This field is based on verifiable facts and reliable evidence—not imagination or myth.

4. It covers significant events such as wars, migrations, discoveries, leadership changes, and independence movements.

5. Example: Nigeria gained independence on 1 October 1960, achieving self-rule after decades of British colonial rule—an event central to modern Nigerian history.

6. Global example: The fall of the Berlin Wall on 9 November 1989 symbolized the end of the Cold War and led to Germany's reunification, marking a major historical turning point.

ORIGIN OF HISTORY

1. The term "history" originates from the Greek word "historia", meaning "inquiry" or "investigation."

2. Scholars like the Greeks began writing about the past during the 5th century BC.

3. Herodotus (c. 484–425 BC), born in Halicarnassus (today's Bodrum, Turkey), is honored as the Father of History for authoring Histories, a systematic account of the Greco-Persian Wars.

4. His travels across Persia, Egypt, and Scythia helped him collect eyewitness accounts, which he critically examined to trace causes and effects in history.

5. In pre-literate African societies, history was preserved through oral traditions, such as storytelling among the Yoruba, Hausa, and Ashanti peoples.

HISTORY AND STORYTELLING

1. Storytelling involves narrating tales, which can be real, fictional, or symbolic.

2. History focuses on real events, supported by concrete evidence and a logical sequence.

3. Storytelling might include imaginative or exaggerated elements; history aims to record actual occurrences truthfully.

4. In Africa, before written records, historical knowledge was transmitted orally—griots in West Africa served as the custodians of memory.

5. Griots preserved genealogies, royal histories, and social events through music, poetry, and praise songs.

6. Oral epic such as the Epic of Sunjata (13th-century Mali) are corroborated by archaeological findings from West Africa.

TYPES OF TRADITIONAL STORIES

1. Myths: Narratives explaining the origins of the world, nature, or culture.

2. Legends: Stories based on real people, often embellished—like Queen Amina of Zazzau, a 16th-century Hausa warrior queen.

3. Fables: Short tales, typically with talking animals, used to teach moral lessons.

4. Folktales: Community-based stories shared across generations for entertainment and ethical guidance.

IMPORTANCE OF HISTORY

1. History helps individuals and societies understand their identity, origins, and cultural heritage.

2. It teaches us to learn from past mistakes, aiding better decision-making today and tomorrow.

3. It highlights the achievements of heroes and leaders (e.g., Dr. Nnamdi Azikiwe, Obafemi Awolowo, Ahmadu Bello in Nigeria).

4. It enhances critical thinking, enabling analysis and truth verification supported by evidence.

5. It fosters national unity and pride, through shared historical experiences, like independence and civil struggles.

6. It supports civic education by tracing the evolution of political institutions and governance.

7. Historical knowledge helps young people grow into responsible citizens, understanding justice, rights, and societal changes.

Week 2 – History vs Storytelling

Date	Week 2
Topic	History vs Storytelling
Objectives / Learning Outcomes	Compare history with storytelling and identify types of storytelling
Summary (Insight)	History is factual, while storytelling includes myths and legends.
Key Words / New Terms	Myth, Legend, Fable, Folktale, Fiction, Fact
Application	I will compare one traditional tale with actual historical records.
Student Engagement:	
What I Have Learnt?	
Skills Acquired	
My Question(s) / Evaluation	
Action Goal	

WEEK 2

HISTORY VS STORYTELLING

HISTORY

1. History is the accurate study and recording of past events, backed by evidence such as documents, artifacts, inscriptions, and firsthand accounts.

2. Historians analyze primary sources, like letters, official records, and eyewitness accounts, to verify facts and reconstruct timelines.

3. Chronology in history ensures that we understand when events happened, how they relate, and their consequences.

4. Critical thinking is central: historians evaluate bias, reliability, and completeness of sources before drawing conclusions .

5. Example: The Greco-Persian Wars (499–449 BC) were documented by Herodotus through interviews across Greece and Persia, later confirmed by archaeological findings at Thermopylae and Marathon .

STORYTELLING

1. Storytelling is the narration of tales—sometimes based on history, often embellished for dramatic effect or to teach morals.

2. It is not rigidly chronological and can include myths, legends, folktales, and fables.

3. Stories are shaped by culture, environment, and the storyteller's creativity—details change with each retelling .

4. Storytelling preserves culture, values, and identity—like griots in Mali who maintain genealogies and royal histories through music and praise songs.

5. Oral epics, such as the Epic of Sunjata, date back to the 13th century and recount how Sundiata Keita founded the Mali Empire circa 1217–1255 AD, blending history with myth.

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN HISTORY AND STORYTELLING

1. History is evidence-based; storytelling often relies on memories, imagination, or moral teaching.

2. History follows a logical and chronological sequence; storytelling may start in the middle or use flashbacks.

3. Storytellers may change details based on audience, time, and context; historians must check facts and acknowledge uncertainty.

4. Historical narratives aim to explain causes and effects; stories often center on themes and morals, like the cunning tortoise in West African fables.

5. Storytelling connects communities through shared values and traditions, while history seeks universal insights from events like independence, wars, and revolutions.

IMPORTANCE OF UNDERSTANDING BOTH HISTORY AND STORYTELLING

1. Storytelling helps preserve traditions and culture, especially where literacy was limited.

2. Storytelling can inspire critical engagement with the past—it prompts questions historians investigate.

3. Studying both allows us to appreciate cultural diversity and understand how narratives shape identity.

4. Oral histories like Sunjata offer cultural insight and communal memory, while archaeology and documents help historians verify and date these stories.

5. Combining storytelling and historical methods enriches our knowledge—what one preserves emotionally, the other confirms factually. For example, Mali's national anthem draws its lyrics from the Sunjata epic, blending myth and nationhood.

Week 3 – Importance of Studying History

Date	Week 3
Topic	Importance of Studying History
Objectives / Learning Outcomes	Understand benefits of history to individuals, society, and the nation
Summary (Insight)	History helps us understand the past and make better decisions today.
Key Words / New Terms	Patriotism, Identity, Legacy, Wisdom
Application	I can use historical lessons to avoid repeating past mistakes.
Student Engagement:	
What I Have Learnt?	
Skills Acquired	
My Question(s) / Evaluation	
Action Goal	

WEEK 3

IMPORTANCE OF STUDYING HISTORY

IMPORTANCE TO THE INDIVIDUAL

1. History helps people understand their roots, identity, and ancestry. Knowing where we come from strengthens our sense of self.

2. It teaches critical thinking. By examining past events—like the Great Depression (1929–1939) or the Nigerian Civil War (1967–1970)—we develop analytical skills to question and learn.

3. It serves as a moral guide. Studying figures such as Nelson Mandela teaches courage, forgiveness, and perseverance.

4. History inspires and builds personal resilience. Learning how individuals overcame adversity can guide our own lives.

5. It equips students with research and reasoning skills important for careers and informed citizenship.

IMPORTANCE TO SOCIETY

1. History creates a shared cultural heritage, fostering national pride (e.g., celebrating Independence Day, October 1, 1960 in Nigeria).

2. It promotes social cohesion by presenting a collective memory of past achievements and tragedies.

3. It supports democratic citizenship. Understanding historical governance helps citizens participate and hold leaders accountable.

4. History highlights warning signs of conflict, genocide, or poverty—allowing society to avoid repeating them (e.g., lessons from the Holocaust).

5. It preserves cultural diversity, recognizing the contributions and histories of different groups, such as the Igbo, Yoruba, Hausa, and Tiv people in Nigeria.

IMPORTANCE TO THE NATION

1. History shapes national identity and pride, with heroes like Dr. Nnamdi Azikiwe, Obafemi Awolowo, and Funmilayo Ransome-Kuti serving as unifying symbols.

2. It informs public policy; leaders study past governance models to shape better policies on education, healthcare, and economy.

3. Economically, history builds cultural tourism, focusing on sites like Ife, Benin City, and Sukur, which preserve heritage and attract visitors.

4. It supports conflict resolution and reconciliation, by teaching understanding of past conflicts (e.g., Post-Civil War efforts in Nigeria).

5. History helps nations better manage change and globalization, understanding how decisions—like joining international agreements—are rooted in past choices.

OVERALL BENEFITS & SKILLS DEVELOPED STUDYING HISTORY

1. Enhances critical analysis—evaluating bias, reliability, and relevance of source.

2. Fosters civic responsibility and justice, by examining rights struggles, such as the women's suffrage movement.

3. Develops empathy and global awareness—learning how diverse groups experienced injustice (e.g., indigenous displacement in Sequoia National Park).

4. Builds communication and writing skills—structuring evidence-based arguments is a hallmark of historical study.

5. Prepares students to fit into modern, interdependent societies, understanding how local and global events connect (e.g., the Black Lives Matter movement emerged from historical biases).

KEY HISTORICAL DATES, NAMES & EXAMPLES

1. Great Depression (1929–1939): Worldwide economic hardship that shaped global welfare policies.

2. Nigerian Civil War (1967–1970): Taught lessons on unity, nationalism, and consequences of ethnic division.

3. Holocaust (1941–1945): A critical reminder of the dangers of discrimination and unchecked power.

4. Nelson Mandela (1918–2013): South African leader who ended apartheid and became a global symbol of reconciliation.

5. Women's Suffrage Movement: The struggle that led to women gaining the right to vote (e.g., Nigeria's 1979 Constitution granted women voting rights).

6. Sequoia National Park founding (1890): A conservation milestone that displaced indigenous peoples—highlighting conflicting value systems.

Week 4 – Characteristics of History

Date	Week 4
Topic	Characteristics of History
Objectives / Learning Outcomes	Describe the basic features that define historical knowledge
Summary (Insight)	History is factual, human-centered, and follows a timeline (chronology).
Key Words / New Terms	Facts, Chronological, Human-centered, Evidence
Application	I will create a timeline of important events in my family or nation.
Student Engagement:	
What I Have Learnt?	
Skills Acquired	
My Question(s) / Evaluation	
Action Goal	

WEEK 4

CHARACTERISTICS OF HISTORY

HUMAN-CENTERED

1. History focuses on human experiences—it explores people's actions, decisions, cultures, and interactions across time.

2. It examines various aspects: political leaders, social groups, economic systems, science, religion, and culture .

3. For example, the Renaissance (14th–17th century) in Europe centered on human achievement in art, science, and philosophy.

BASED ON FACTS AND EVIDENCE

1. Historical findings are grounded in evidence—artifacts, documents, inscriptions, records, and eyewitness accounts.

2. Historians critically evaluate authenticity, bias, reliability, and context before accepting facts .

3. Example: Thucydides (c. 460–395 BC), author of History of the Peloponnesian War, emphasized facts, chronology, and causal analysis over myth .

LOGICAL AND CHRONOLOGICAL

1. Events are arranged chronologically, enabling understanding of cause and effect and the progression of events.

2. Historians construct timelines—e.g., the Nigerian Civil War (1967–1970) followed key events dating back to independence in 1960.

3. Logical sequencing separates myths and legends from factual history.

INTEPRETATIVE AND ANALYTICAL

1. History isn't just a list of events—it involves explaining why things happened, identifying causes, motives, and contexts.

2. Edward H. Carr's What Is History? (1961) explains that history requires interpretation—"facts are nothing until labeled" .

3. Historians analyze various interpretations—political, economic, social, ideological—to construct a balanced narrative.

SUBJECT TO CHANGE

1. History is a dynamic field—as new evidence emerges, interpretations evolve. What was considered accurate yesterday may be revised today (e.g., reinterpretations of colonial narratives).

2. The Annales School (early 20th century, France) shifted focus from individual events to long-term social, geographic, and economic trends ("la longue durée") .

3. Example: Archaeological discoveries at Ife (Osun State) in the 20th century reshaped understanding of Yoruba ancient art and city life.

COMPREHENSIVE AND MULTIDISCIPLINARY

1. History draws from archaeology, anthropology, sociology, economics, political science, and literary sources .

2. The study of human history includes transitioning from hunter-gatherers (circa 300,000 years ago in Africa) through urban civilizations, religious revolutions, colonization, industrialization, and globalization

3. Example: Understanding the Industrial Revolution (18th–19th century) requires knowledge of technological innovation, labor history, economics, and environmental impact.

CAUSAL AND CONTEXTUAL

1. History explores cause and effect—why actions happened and their consequences .

2. It situates events within their social, economic, political, cultural, and environmental settings.

3. Example: The outbreak of WWI in 1914 is understood by examining nationalism, imperial competition, alliance systems, and the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand.

Week 5 – Sources of History (Overview)

Date	Week 5
Topic	Sources of History (Overview)
Objectives / Learning Outcomes	Identify the different types of sources used in studying history
Summary (Insight)	Sources of history include primary, secondary, and tertiary sources.
Key Words / New Terms	Source, Evidence, Primary, Secondary, Tertiary
Application	I will classify documents I find into different types of sources.
Student Engagement:	
What I Have Learnt?	
Skills Acquired	
My Question(s) / Evaluation	
Action Goal	

WEEK 5

SOURCES OF HISTORY (OVERVIEW)

MEANING OF SOURCES OF HISTORY

1. Sources of history are materials, objects, or records that provide information about past events, societies, and individuals.

2. They are the evidence historians use to reconstruct and interpret the past accurately.

3. Reliable sources must be critiqued for authenticity, context, and bias.

4. Examples include documents, artifacts, oral accounts, inscriptions, photographs, and archaeological finds.

CLASSIFICATION INTO PRIMARY, SECONDARY, TERTIARY SOURCES

PRIMARY SOURCES

1. These are first-hand records created at the time of the event or by direct witnesses.

2. Examples include diaries, letters, speeches, government records, ancient inscriptions, photographs, and artifacts like the Benin Bronzes from Edo State (14th–16th centuries).

3. Oral histories from witnesses of Nigeria's independence in 1960 or the Biafra War (1967–1970) are also primary.

4. Archaeological artifacts like Nok terracotta figurines (500 BC–200 AD) and the Ikom monoliths (~200 AD) are primary sources documenting early civilizations.

SECONDARY SOURCES

1. Secondary sources are interpretations or analyses based on primary materials.

2. They include textbooks, biographies, academic papers, documentaries, and historical commentaries.

3. For example, histories about the Benin Kingdom, written using archaeological evidence and artifacts, are secondary sources.

TERTIARY SOURCES

1. These are summaries or compendia of primary and secondary materials, not offering new analysis.

2. Examples include encyclopedias, dictionaries, atlases, bibliographies, and guidebooks.

3. Resources like Wikipedia or general reference books provide broad overviews and entry points to deeper study.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATIVE POINTS

RELIABILITY AND CRITICISM OF SOURCES

1. Historians assess sources by authenticity, examining authorship, location, date, and intended purpose.

2. They cross-check facts—e.g., combining written colonial records with oral tales and archaeology to confirm events in early Nigerian history.

ROLES OF ORAL SOURCES IN AFRICAN HISTORY

1. Oral tradition is crucial in African societies, preserving narratives on origins, laws, and migrations.

2. Though subject to memory loss or embellishment, criticism and cross-referencing with archaeology enhance reliability.

KEY EXAMPLES FROM NIGERIA

1. Benin Bronzes – Brass and bronze artifacts from Edo State illustrating the Oba's court life (14th–16th centuries).

2. Nok Terracotta – Sculptures from Kaduna State dating back to 500 BC–200 AD, among Africa's earliest art.

3. Ikom Monoliths – Stone carvings featuring faces and patterns in Cross River State (circa 200 AD).

4. Ekpu Oro Figures – Wooden ancestral statues from Oron, over 2,300 years old, preserving lineage and belief systems.

5. Archives and Libraries – Like National Archives, Ibadan, containing colonial documents, treaties, and missionary records; also modern items like letters from Nigerian leaders of 1960.

INTEGRATION FOR HISTORICAL STUDY

1. A multidisciplinary approach combines documents, art, oral tradition, and archaeology to build comprehensive histories.

2. Explanations of early human development rely on both archaeological finds (e.g., Homo sapiens origins in Africa) and anthropological context.

3. Historians continually update history—new findings can rewrite past knowledge, such as revised insights into Great Zulu Kingdom structures, revealed through excavations

Week 6 – Primary Sources of History

Date	Week 6
Topic	Primary Sources of History
Objectives / Learning Outcomes	Understand what primary sources are and give examples
Summary (Insight)	Primary sources are original records like oral tradition and artifacts.
Key Words / New Terms	Artifact, Oral tradition, Eye-witness, Evidence
Application	I will ask an elder to narrate a true story from their youth.
Student Engagement:	
What I Have Learnt?	
Skills Acquired	
My Question(s) / Evaluation	
Action Goal	

WEEK 6

PRIMARY SOURCES OF HISTORY

MEANING OF PRIMARY SOURCES

1. Primary sources are first-hand records or evidence created at the time of historical events or by people who experienced them directly.

2. They offer direct insight into the past, and do not rely on interpretation by others.

3. Historians use them for authentic evidence—crucial for accurate understanding of events.

4. They are often irreplaceable time capsules, requiring careful preservation and study.

EXAMPLES OF PRIMARY SOURCES

1. Oral Traditions

- These include stories, proverbs, songs, chants, poetry, and legends, passed down verbally in societies without written records.
- They are vital in African history—for example, Yoruba epic poems and Hausa legends preserve genealogies, clan histories, and moral codes.
- Case studies: Kenneth Dike's work on Niger Delta and Saburi Biobaku's study of the Egba relied heavily on oral narratives to reconstruct 19th-century histories.

2. Artifacts

Physical objects like tools, pottery, sculptures, and jewelry, excavated or collected from past civilizations.

Nigerian examples:

- Benin Bronzes (Edo, 14th–16th centuries)—bronze plaques and heads from the Oba's court.
- Nok Terracotta (Kaduna, 500 BC–200 AD)—early pottery figures.
- Igbo-Ukwu bronzes (Anambra, 9th century AD)—complex ritual objects and beads.
- Ikom Monoliths (Cross River, circa 200 CE)—stone carvings with symbolic patterns.
- Apapa Hoard (Lagos area, 16th century)—bronze rituals now in the British Museum.

3. Eye-Witness Accounts (Oral Evidence)

- Accounts from people who directly saw or lived through historical events. Examples: Survivors of Nigeria's Civil War (1967–1970) sharing personal experiences; testimonies of those who witnessed Nigeria's independence on 1 October 1960.
- In scholarly practice, historians record these testimonies carefully to cross-validate authenticity.

4. Written Documents & Records

- Though not listed in your subtopics, these often overlap with primary sources: include letters, diaries, government records, treaties, inscriptions, and early newspapers.
- For instance, colonial archives in Ibadan and Kaduna hold treaties and correspondence key to understanding 20th-century governance in Nigeria.

5. Visual Records

- Photographs, paintings, maps, and even sculptures created in the period under study. Example: Anyanwu, a 1954–55 bronze sculpture by Ben Enwonwu, marks Nigeria's emerging post-colonial identity and sits outside the National Museum, Lagos—also replicated at the United Nations in 1966.

IMPORTANCE OF PRIMARY SOURCES

1. They provide direct evidence of past events, unfiltered by later interpretations.

2. They aid in building chronological narratives, determining who, what, where, and when.

3. They allow historians to cross-reference material, validating oral, written, or archaeological records.

4. They preserve cultural memory, such as clan histories, festivals, and local traditions through stories and music.

5. They offer insight into daily life and social values, beyond major political events.

6. Examples: Tribal artifacts reveal ancient craftsmanship; colonially recorded treaties show economic priorities; war testimonies illustrate human experiences.

SOURCE CRITICISM & RELIABILITY

1. Historians must assess sources by checking authenticity (origin, date, authorship).

2. Oral sources are scrutinized for consistency, memory bias, and repetition accuracy.

3. Artifacts are dated using methods like radiocarbon (C-14) dating, contextual excavation.

4. Verifying through cross-disciplinary methods—e.g., Yoruba glass artifacts confirmed through chemistry and archaeology.

Week 8 – Secondary Sources of History

Date	Week 8
Topic	Secondary Sources of History
Objectives / Learning Outcomes	Identify examples of secondary sources and their importance
Summary (Insight)	These are written interpretations such as textbooks and journals.
Key Words / New Terms	Textbook, Journal, Biography, Interpretation
Application	I will use my textbook to verify a historical story I heard.
Student Engagement:	
What I Have Learnt?	
Skills Acquired	
My Question(s) / Evaluation	
Action Goal	

WEEK 8

SECONDARY SOURCES OF HISTORY

MEANING OF SECONDARY SOURCES

1. Secondary sources are interpretations, analyses, or summaries of historical events, based on primary sources rather than direct experience.

2. They are produced by researchers, historians, or scholars after the events occurred, often using multiple sources to draw conclusions.

3. These sources help provide context, background, and scholarly perspectives on past events by connecting facts and explaining significance.

4. A secondary source may be influenced by the author's biases, background, or contemporary viewpoints, so critical evaluation is essential.

5. They serve as a bridge between raw historical data and broader understanding, making complex information accessible and easier to digest.

EXAMPLES OF SECONDARY SOURCES

1. Textbooks and Academic Books

- Designed to teach students, textbooks synthesize primary and secondary sources into coherent narratives (e.g., JSS1 History textbooks).
- Scholarly books like Howard Zinn’s A People’s History of the United States offer in-depth thematic and critical perspectives.

2. Journals and Articles

- Peer-reviewed publications (e.g., Journal of African History) include detailed studies on specific historical topics.
- Articles discuss new findings, evaluate evidence, and propose theories, often contributing to academic discourse.

3. Biographies

- Works like Wole Soyinka’s You Must Set Forth at Dawn or accounts of Nnamdi Azikiwe compile personal archives, letters, and interviews to narrate lives of individuals.
- These sources interpret and contextualize primary material such as diaries and interviews.

4. Media (Documentaries, Historical Films, Newspapers)

- Documentaries—like Ken Burns' The Civil War—combine archival footage, expert interviews, and narration to present concise historical stories.
- Modern media news retrospectives and newspaper retrospectives explain historical events with current understanding.

5. Reference Works (Encyclopedias, Atlases)

- Collections like Britannica or specialized atlases summarize and clarify vast amounts of historical data.
- While useful for overviews, these are sometimes considered tertiary if they lack analysis.

FEATURES OF SECONDARY SOURCES

1. They are interpretative—offering explanations and connecting facts beyond raw data.

2. They are produced after the events and rely on primary sources (e.g. documents, artifacts, oral testimonies).

3. They often synthesize multiple primary sources to build comprehensive arguments.

4. These works aim for objectivity, but biases and interpretations vary depending on the author and time of writing.

5. Secondary sources typically include citations and references, allowing readers to verify original evidence.

ADVANTAGES OF SECONDARY SOURCES

1. They offer context and explanation, saving time in understanding complex events (e.g., the Nigerian Civil War).

2. They are often easier to access than original documents or artifacts.

3. They provide balanced perspectives by comparing evidence from multiple sources.

4. Useful for educational purposes, offering structured knowledge in textbooks and handbooks.

LIMITATIONS OF SECONDARY SOURCES

1. They may introduce author bias or interpretation errors.

2. They might generalize and omit details from primary sources.

3. Being authored after events, they may lack the authenticity and immediacy of original materials.

4. Outdated works may be superseded by newer research—evaluating publication date is important.

EVALUATION OF SECONDARY SOURCES

1. Check the author's credentials and expertise in the subject area .

2. Evaluate the publication's date and relevance to ensure up-to-date interpretation .

3. Assess the use of evidence: are claims supported by citations, references to archives or oral sources?

4. Identify potential bias—consider social, cultural, or political influences on the author .

5. Compare with multiple secondary accounts to see where interpretations converge or differ.

Week 9 – Tertiary Sources of History

Date	Week 9
Topic	Tertiary Sources of History
Objectives / Learning Outcomes	Recognize reference materials and how they support historical study
Summary (Insight)	Tertiary sources summarize or organize other sources (e.g. encyclopedias).
Key Words / New Terms	Encyclopedia, Dictionary, Bibliography, Index
Application	I will use a history encyclopedia to look up “Oduduwa”.
Student Engagement:	
What I Have Learnt?	
Skills Acquired	
My Question(s) / Evaluation	
Action Goal	

WEEK 9

TERTIARY SOURCES OF HISTORY

MEANING OF TERTIARY SOURCES

1. Tertiary sources are compilations or summaries of primary and secondary sources and do not offer original analysis or firsthand content .

2. They provide background context, definitions, indexes, and overviews—ideal for initial understanding.

3. Often found in reference materials, their main role is to guide learners toward deeper primary and secondary resources.

EXAMPLES OF TERTIARY SOURCES

1. Encyclopedias such as Encyclopedia Britannica and Wikipedia summarize historical events, dates, and biographies.

2. Textbooks: Standard JSS1 History textbooks are tertiary when they compile information without new interpretation.

3. Dictionaries and Glossaries: Define historical terms—e.g., historia, griot, artifact.

4. Atlases and Chronologies: Visual tools organizing dates, locations, and events geographically and temporally.

5. Bibliographies and Indexes: Direct students to primary and secondary sources on topics like Nigerian kingdoms.

6. Almanacs and Yearbooks: Provide annual summaries—e.g., Africa Yearbook listing major events like Biafra War timelines.

FEATURES AND CHARACTERISTICS TERTIARY SOURCES

1. They do not present new research, but help users locate it by compiling material.

2. They offer neutral or widely accepted information without heavy interpretation.

3. Their value lies in organizing knowledge, listing sources, and providing clear overviews.

ROLES OF TERTIARY SOURCES IN HISTORICAL STUDY

1. They serve as starting points—helping students identify key dates, names, and events to research further.

2. Historians and learners use them to locate relevant primary/secondary sources efficiently.

3. Ideal for revision and recap, offering concise summaries of important topics like independence, wars, and cultural developments.

4. In BECE/NECO preparation, they help learners quickly review core content, but deeper study requires primary and secondary sources.

EVALUATION OF TERTIARY SOURCES

1. Assess authority—is the encyclopedic entry written by experts or peer-reviewed editors?

2. Evaluate currency—ensure up-to-date facts, e.g., latest archaeological findings in Benin City (2020s).

3. Check coverage—do they mention key events like Nok culture (500 BC) or Queen Amina's reign (c.1533–1610)?

4. Use them for contextual foundation, then proceed to deeper sources for detailed understanding.

Week 10 – Ways of Accessing History

Date	Week 10
Topic	Ways of Accessing History
Objectives / Learning Outcomes	Identify and explain how history is accessed through places and events
Summary (Insight)	History can be accessed through libraries, museums, and festivals.
Key Words / New Terms	Museum, Library, Archive, Festival, Exhibition
Application	I will visit a local museum or read about it online.
Student Engagement:	
What I Have Learnt?	
Skills Acquired	
My Question(s) / Evaluation	
Action Goal	

WEEK 10

WAYS OF ACCESSING HISTORY

MUSEUMS

1. Museums are institutions that preserve, display, and interpret objects of historical, cultural, or artistic importance.

2. The National Museum, Lagos, established in 1957, is Nigeria's most prominent, known for its collection of Benin Bronzes, Ife sculptures, and the bullet-ridden car of General Murtala Mohammed.

3. The Esie Museum in Kwara State, established in 1945, is the first museum in Nigeria and houses hundreds of soapstone figures.

4. Museums help people visualize the past and understand the context behind artifacts and the people who used them.

5. Museum visits are essential for connecting theoretical classroom knowledge with real-life historical evidence.

ARCHIVES

1. Archives store original documents such as letters, treaties, colonial records, maps, and personal papers.

2. The National Archives of Nigeria have centers in Ibadan (est. 1951), Kaduna, and Enugu, housing important records of the colonial and early post-colonial periods.

3. Students and researchers use archives to gain insight into Nigeria's political and administrative evolution.

4. For instance, letters between colonial officers and local chiefs during the Lugard administration (1914–1919) can be found in these archives.

5. Archives preserve the authenticity and reliability of historical data.

ORAL TRADITIONS / HISTORIES

1. Oral tradition involves passing down historical knowledge through word of mouth—stories, songs, chants, and proverbs.

2. In pre-literate African societies, griots or oral historians (such as those in Mali and Senegal) preserved the history of kings, wars, and cultural customs.

3. The Epic of Sundiata, which chronicles the rise of the Mali Empire in the 13th century, was preserved for centuries by oral storytellers.

4. In Nigeria, communities like the Yoruba, Igbo, and Hausa maintain family and community histories through oral lineage accounts.

5. Oral traditions provide emotional and cultural context that written records sometimes miss.

ARCHAEOLOGICAL SITES

1. Archaeology involves excavating historical sites to uncover tools, structures, and other material remains of past societies.

2. The Nok Culture, dated to around 500 BC, discovered in Kaduna State, revealed terracotta sculptures that prove advanced artistic and social development.

3. In Ife, bronze and terracotta heads from around the 12th to 15th centuries reveal a sophisticated Yoruba kingdom.

4. Benin City was excavated to uncover moats, bronze plaques, and evidence of early urbanization.

5. Archaeological findings help reconstruct ancient history even in the absence of written records.

LIBRARIES AND RESEARCH CENTRES

1. Libraries are organized collections of books, journals, manuscripts, and newspapers used for study and research.

2. The National Library of Nigeria, established in 1964, serves as a major research hub for students and historians.

3. University libraries, such as those at University of Ibadan and Ahmadu Bello University, hold rare materials on Nigerian history and politics.

4. Research centres often maintain specialized collections, including early missionary writings and ethnographic reports.

5. These institutions support academic inquiry, reference, and preservation of written history.

DIGITAL SOURCES AND ONLINE PLATFORMS

1. Digital access to history has expanded through websites, online archives, virtual museums, and educational platforms.

2. Projects like Google Arts & Culture and British Museum Virtual Tour provide access to historical objects and exhibitions from anywhere in the world.

3. Platforms like Wikipedia and JSTOR offer free or subscription-based access to secondary and tertiary sources.

4. Oral histories are now being recorded, digitized, and stored online by universities and archives—like the Smithsonian Institution's Oral History Program.

5. In Nigeria, apps and platforms are being developed to record elders' testimonies, digitize documents, and teach local history through animations and storytelling.

IMPORTANCE OF MULTIPLE ACCESS METHODS

1. Using various access methods helps bridge gaps in historical knowledge, especially in societies with limited written records.

2. Cross-verifying data from museums, archives, oral sources, and digital platforms improves accuracy and critical thinking.

3. Each method—whether oral, written, or digital—offers unique strengths that together form a fuller picture of the past.

4. Exposure to different sources improves historical inquiry skills and promotes cultural pride.

5. These diverse resources equip students with tools for exam preparation, debate, storytelling, and national consciousness.

Week 11 – Importance of History (Expanded)

Date	Week 11
Topic	Importance of History (Expanded)
Objectives / Learning Outcomes	Reemphasize history's value to individuals, society, and the nation
Summary (Insight)	History teaches values, helps identity, and shapes leadership.
Key Words / New Terms	Nation-building, Identity, Unity, Wisdom
Application	I will analyze how past events influence decisions today.
Student Engagement:	
What I Have Learnt?	
Skills Acquired	
My Question(s) / Evaluation	
Action Goal	

WEEK 11

IMPORTANCE OF HISTORY

IMPORTANCE OF HISTORY TO THE INDIVIDUAL

1. History helps individuals understand their identity, origins, and the roles of their ancestors. For example, learning about the Benin Kingdom allows Edo children to appreciate their royal heritage dating back to the Ogiso dynasty (circa 900 AD).

2. It develops critical thinking by teaching how to analyze causes and effects of past events—like understanding why Nigeria was colonized in 1900 and the outcomes of colonial rule.

3. Studying history fosters moral lessons by showing the consequences of actions, such as the impact of greed and betrayal seen in the fall of Old Oyo Empire in the 19th century.

4. It boosts memory, reading, and communication skills, especially through storytelling, timelines, and historical analysis.

5. It builds pride and inspiration through heroic figures like Queen Amina of Zazzau (16th century), Usman dan Fodio (1754–1817), and Obafemi Awolowo, helping individuals emulate leadership and courage.

IMPORTANCE OF HISTORY TO SOCIETY

1. History strengthens social unity and national identity by reminding people of shared struggles and achievements—such as Nigeria's independence from Britain on October 1, 1960.

2. It promotes peace and reconciliation by revealing past mistakes. For instance, understanding the Nigerian Civil War (1967–1970) helps prevent future ethnic conflict.

3. History preserves cultural values and traditions through festivals, oral traditions, and historical monuments like the Ogbunike Caves or the Zuma Rock, which have spiritual and historical significance.

4. It teaches the origin of laws and political systems, such as the roles of chiefs, emirs, and obas in pre-colonial governance, and how these systems evolved under colonialism and independence.

5. It helps societies resist false narratives or foreign domination by building pride in indigenous civilizations like Nok, Ife, and Kanem-Bornu.

IMPORTANCE OF HISTORY TO THE NATION

1. History guides national development planning by analyzing successes and failures in governance—like the lessons from the First Republic (1960–1966) and military regimes.

2. It strengthens patriotism by educating citizens on heroes of the nation such as Nnamdi Azikiwe, Ahmadu Bello, Funmilayo Ransome-Kuti, and Herbert Macaulay.

3. It aids diplomacy by teaching about historical international relations—such as trade with Portuguese sailors in the 15th century or the Berlin Conference of 1884–1885, which divided African territories among Europeans.

4. History is used in writing national constitutions, laws, and civic documents by studying past legal systems and political frameworks.

5. It helps in defending the country's territorial integrity, especially by knowing past borders, wars, and treaties—such as the Anglo-Aro War (1901–1902), which led to British conquest of Eastern Nigeria.

GENERAL BENEFITS OF STUDYING HISTORY

1. History enhances research and academic careers, including roles as historians, teachers, journalists, archaeologists, and museum curators.

2. It supports national memory preservation—monuments, museums, archives, and commemorative holidays (e.g., Democracy Day – June 12).

3. It encourages global awareness, allowing learners to study other civilizations (Egypt, Greece, Rome) and compare with African history.

4. It shapes political maturity by helping citizens understand governance structures, constitutions, and leadership qualities.

5. Studying history empowers youths to become informed, responsible citizens who understand their roots and make wise decisions for the future.

Week 12 – History Makers

Date	Week 12
Topic	History Makers
Objectives / Learning Outcomes	Identify important history professionals and their work
Summary (Insight)	People like archaeologists and historians help preserve history.
Key Words / New Terms	Archaeologist, Historian, Paleontologist, Cryptographer
Application	I will research a famous historian or archaeologist.
Student Engagement:	
What I Have Learnt?	
Skills Acquired	
My Question(s) / Evaluation	
Action Goal	

WEEK 12

HISTORY MAKERS

MEANING OF HISTORY MAKERS

1. History makers are individuals or groups who have significantly influenced the course of events in the past, leaving a lasting impact on their communities, nations, or the world.

2. They can be leaders, inventors, scholars, warriors, reformers, or ordinary people whose actions helped shape society.

3. History makers may be found in areas such as politics, religion, education, warfare, science, culture, and activism.

4. Their contributions help us understand how societies evolved, why certain changes happened, and how we can learn from their successes and mistakes.

HISTORIANS

1. Historians are professionals who study, interpret, and write about the past using sources such as documents, oral accounts, and artifacts.

2. They help record and preserve history by creating books, papers, lectures, and educational content.

3. Famous historians include Jacob Ade Ajayi, a Nigerian scholar known for promoting African perspectives in history, and Herodotus, a Greek historian regarded as the "Father of History".

4. Historians work in universities, museums, research institutes, and can also advise governments on historical matters.

ARCHAEOLOGISTS

1. Archaeologists are experts who study human history through the excavation and analysis of physical remains like bones, tools, pottery, and ruins.

2. Their work helps to uncover ancient civilizations such as the Nok Culture in Nigeria (500 BC–200 AD) or Great Zimbabwe in Southern Africa (11th–15th centuries).

3. In Nigeria, archaeologists helped discover the Ife bronze and terracotta heads, which date back to the 12th–15th centuries and reveal the artistic achievements of the Yoruba people.

4. Prominent Nigerian archaeologists include Professor Ekpo Eyo, who helped develop the National Commission for Museums and Monuments.

PALEONTOLOGISTS

1. Paleontologists study prehistoric life forms, especially through fossils of plants, animals, and early human species.

2. Their discoveries help us understand human origins and the natural world before written history.

3. In East Africa's Olduvai Gorge, fossils found by the Leakey family revealed early human ancestors dating back over 2 million years.

4. Though less common in Nigeria, paleontologists contribute to understanding the evolution of African environments and species.

CRYPTOGRAPHERS

1. Cryptographers are experts in codes, symbols, and hidden messages often used in communication, particularly during wars or secret movements.

2. They help historians decode ancient scripts or messages, especially those that are not written in modern languages.

3. In African history, secret societies like the Ekpe society in southeastern Nigeria used symbolic writing systems like Nsibidi to record laws and customs.

4. During World War II, cryptography was critical for military strategy, and historians today use those decoded messages to study wartime decisions.

OTHER SIGNIFICANT HISTORY MAKERS IN NIGERIA

1. Queen Amina of Zazzau (16th century) – A military leader who expanded her territory through warfare and established strong trade routes in Northern Nigeria.

2. Usman dan Fodio (1754–1817) – Led the Sokoto Jihad to reform Islam in Hausaland and founded the Sokoto Caliphate, one of the largest empires in 19th-century West Africa.

3. Oba Ewuare the Great (c. 1440–1473) – A powerful ruler of Benin Kingdom, known for city wall construction and expanding the Benin Empire's influence.

4. Nnamdi Azikiwe (1904–1996) – The first President of Nigeria and a key nationalist figure who fought for independence.

5. Funmilayo Ransome-Kuti (1900–1978) – A women's rights activist and educationist who challenged colonial policies and promoted female participation in politics.

6. Herbert Macaulay (1864–1946) – Often called the “Father of Nigerian Nationalism,” he founded the Nigerian National Democratic Party (NNDP) in 1923.

IMPORTANCE OF HISTORY MAKERS

1. They inspire future generations by showing that individuals can change history through courage, wisdom, and action.

2. They help us understand leadership, resistance, innovation, and the power of ideas in shaping society.

3. Their lives offer lessons on cultural pride, nation-building, justice, and the importance of education.

4. History makers are celebrated through monuments, schools, museums, currency, and public holidays (e.g., Independence Day honors nationalist leaders).